

C1 Reading

Academic diagnostic - Reading

Level	C1 - Advanced Academic
Skills assessed	Reading, Listening, Writing, Speaking, Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Format	Academic entrance diagnostic test

Reading

Assessment as interpretation rather than measurement

Educational progress is often treated as if it must be visible, numerical and immediate. Test scores, attendance charts and completion rates are attractive because they create the impression of control. Yet the most important changes in learning may be indirect: a student begins to tolerate uncertainty, notices patterns, asks better questions or becomes less dependent on translation. These shifts are difficult to measure, but they often explain later improvement.

This does not mean that assessment is useless. On the contrary, careful assessment can make invisible progress easier to discuss. The danger appears when numbers become the aim rather than the evidence. A diagnostic test should therefore be read as a map, not a verdict. It shows where the learner is now, which strategies are available and what kind of support is likely to be productive. A strong diagnostic process also accepts asymmetry. One learner may write accurately but speak cautiously; another may understand sophisticated texts yet produce repetitive grammar.

The teacher's task is to interpret these patterns without turning them into a fixed identity. Feedback should be specific enough to guide action and humane enough to keep the learner moving. In this sense, diagnosis is not a gatekeeping ritual. It is a professional conversation about direction.

01 What does the author criticise?

- A. All forms of assessment.
 - B. Students who ask questions.
 - C. The obsession with immediately visible measurement.
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02	Which example of invisible progress is mentioned? A. Winning a prize. B. Memorising all rules. C. Tolerating uncertainty. _____
03	What is the danger of numbers? A. They are always inaccurate. B. They cannot be discussed. C. They can become the aim rather than evidence. _____
04	What does map, not a verdict imply? A. Maps are more beautiful than scores. B. Tests should be removed. C. Diagnostics should guide routes, not define identity. _____
05	What is asymmetry in this context? A. A mathematical concept only. B. A sign of failure. C. Different strengths across skills. _____
06	What should feedback do? A. Sound severe and final. B. Avoid concrete comments. C. Guide action and keep the learner moving. _____

07

What is the author's view of assessment?

- A. Completely useless.
 - B. Only useful for attendance.
 - C. Useful when interpreted carefully.
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08

What genre is the text closest to?

- A. Personal diary.
 - B. Advertisement.
 - C. Reflective academic argument.
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